

CHINA INTERNET: AUTO CLASSIFIED

2Q26 Preview: Stepped-Up Growth Investments and Capital Returns Meet Tough Industry Backdrop; Stay Neutral on Tuhu/Autohome

We remain cautious on China Internet auto classified platforms ahead of the upcoming 1H26 results scheduled for late Aug. As discussed in our [prior note](#), the increase in oil price (domestic price +8% YTD) has put incremental pressure on revenue growth for platforms with relatively high exposure to the traditional ICE market, and industry competition leads to a tougher trade-off between scale and profitability in the context of lower operating leverage. We see our covered companies stepping up investments for long-term revenue growth potential while enhancing shareholder returns; that said, ROI of such investments against this tough industry backdrop is critical to share performance, in our view.

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What's new

Industry wise, domestic passenger vehicle industry beta may improve around September, with a narrowing yoy decline and potentially turning positive by year-end (more details in [GS Asia Mobility Tech Company Call Series](#)). That said, the **potential reversal from the temporary decline of NEV penetration** to 54% in 1H26 (vs. 58% in 2H25) and **auto technology advancements and service integration** (e.g., Xiaomi SkyNomad joining Li Auto with extended-range powertrain requiring maintenance every 3 years or 30k km of operations after the first-time maintenance, which extends the maintenance cycle by 1.5–3x) may pressure TAM expansion of traditional auto media/leads and aftersales services.

Company wise, both Tuhu Car and Autohome appear to double down investments in the infrastructure and new initiatives that management expects may fuel platform growth in the longer term. We estimate c.900 **Tuhu Car workshop net additions** in 1H26E, further acceleration vs. c.330/800 net additions in 1H/2H25 and to 24% workshop count yoy growth, as evidenced by the accelerating merchant app DAU yoy growth. Autohome against the persistent media/leads revenue pressure unveiled its **offline new retail** brand Jiajiahaoche in Jun, which aims to open 600 stores this year primarily in the lower-tier markets via the franchise model. Additionally, Autohome aims to ramp-up its **used car export** business from 2H26E against the large market potential opportunity (e.g., China's used car export volume is only 5% of new car export volume in 1H26 as per CADA).

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Forecast revisions and TP changes

- **Tuhu Car (9690.HK, Neutral):** We raise 2026-28E revenue forecasts by 1%/5%/6% driven by strong workshop expansion, yet lower adj. net profit forecasts by 17% on average primarily due to lower GPM and higher sales and marketing expenses related to online traffic acquisition and offline workshop expansion. Our revised 12m target price is lowered to **HK\$13** (vs. HK\$15 prior) as we reflect the lowered EPS, based on an unchanged target P/E multiple of 15x. Tuhu on Jun 29 announced the share repurchase and cancellation plan of no less than 50mn shares till Jul 2028 (**6% of total shares outstanding**), which we believe implies enhanced capital return commitment against its strong balance sheet (Rmb7bn net cash as of 2025, equivalent to **80%+ of market cap**).
- **Autohome (ATHM/2518.HK, Neutral):** We cut our 2026-28E revenue forecasts by 8% and adj. EPS forecasts by 10% on average, primarily as we lower leads generation and data products revenue on the weak ICE vehicle sales and tight budgets of traditional auto dealerships. That said, we are encouraged by the company's stepped-up capital returns to shareholders equivalent to **22% shareholder return yield** this year; post execution on US\$200mn share repurchase program in Mar-Jul, the company announced a new US\$400mn share repurchase program in Jul 2026 over the next 12 months, in addition to its Rmb1.5bn annual cash dividend commitment. We raise our 12m target prices for ADR/H-share to **US\$19/HK\$37.5** (vs. US\$17/HK\$33 prior), based on unchanged valuation methodology i.e., 1) an 85% weighting to fundamental value based on 13.5x target P/E applied to our 2027E non-GAAP EPS, which is based on the top-quartile of the 12m-fwd P/E multiples over the past year due to enhanced shareholder returns; and 2) a 15% weighting to a theoretical M&A value derived from the unchanged 15x 12m-fwd target P/E multiple.

Tuhu Car (9690.HK)

9690.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$13	Price: HK\$11.68	Upside: 11.3%		
Neutral	GS Forecast				
Market cap: HK\$9.5bn / \$1.2bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Enterprise value: HK\$362.7mn / \$46.3mn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	16,461.6	18,524.6	20,639.7	22,322.0
3m ADTV :HK\$13.8mn/ \$1.8mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	556.4	524.5	780.0	946.2
China	EPS (Rmb) New	0.84	0.65	0.84	1.00
China Internet Verticals	EPS (Rmb) Old	0.84	0.88	0.99	1.10
M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)	19.8	15.4	12.1	10.1
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	P/B (X)	2.7	1.5	1.4	1.2
	Dividend yield (%)	--	--	--	--
	CROCI (%)	21.4	21.2	29.6	34.1
		6/25	12/25	6/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.49	0.35	0.26	0.39

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Prices as of 29 Jul 2026 close.

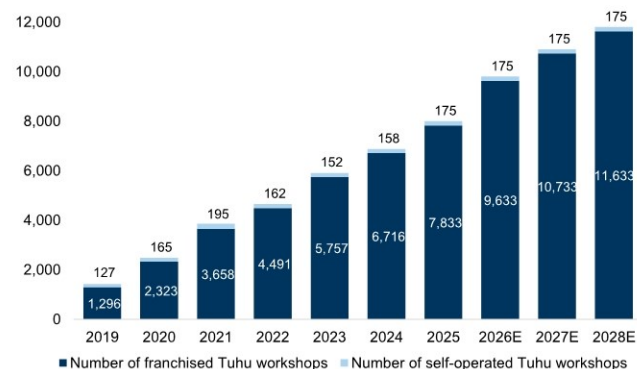
Exhibit 1: Tuhu 1H26E results preview

Rmb mn	1H24	2H24	1H25	2H25	New 1H26E	HoH %	YoY %
Number of Tuhu workshops	6,311	6,874	7,205	8,008	8,908	11%	24%
Revenues	7,126	7,633	7,877	8,585	8,763	2%	11%
Automotive products and services	6,643	7,158	7,362	8,023	8,180	2%	11%
Advertising, franchise and other services	483	474	515	561	583	4%	13%
COGS	(5,280)	(5,732)	(5,895)	(6,599)	(6,733)	-2%	-14%
Gross profit	1,846	1,900	1,982	1,985	2,030	2%	2%
Sales and marketing	(908)	(1,008)	(1,022)	(1,003)	(1,083)	-8%	-6%
General and administrative	(186)	(169)	(194)	(206)	(206)	0%	-6%
Research and development	(302)	(338)	(344)	(420)	(409)	3%	-19%
Operations and support	(283)	(293)	(310)	(372)	(350)	6%	-13%
OPEX, adj.	1,606	1,740	1,765	1,824	1,968	8%	11%
Operating profit	212	119	222	30	46	52%	-79%
Operating profit, adj.	286	187	326	207	126	-39%	-61%
SBC	74	68	104	177	80	-55%	-23%
PBT	289	198	312	111	138	24%	-56%
Tax	(5)	(0)	(5)	2	(3)	NM	46%
Net profit	284	198	307	113	135	20%	-56%
Net profit, adj.	358	266	410	290	215	-26%	-48%

as % revenue	1H24	2H24	1H25	2H25	New 1H26E	HoH (pp)	YoY (pp)
GPM	25.9%	24.9%	25.2%	23.1%	23.2%	0.0	(2.0)
Automotive products and services	23.7%	22.9%	22.8%	20.2%	20.2%	(0.0)	(2.6)
Advertising, franchise and other services	85.9%	88.0%	90.0%	90.7%	90.6%	(0.1)	0.6
Sales and marketing	-12.7%	-13.2%	-13.0%	-11.7%	-12.4%	(0.7)	0.6
General and administrative	-2.6%	-2.2%	-2.5%	-2.4%	-2.3%	0.0	0.1
Research and development	-4.2%	-4.4%	-4.4%	-4.9%	-4.7%	0.2	(0.3)
Operations and support	-4.0%	-3.8%	-3.9%	-4.3%	-4.0%	0.3	(0.1)
OPEX	23.6%	23.7%	23.7%	23.3%	23.4%	0.1	(0.4)
OPEX, adj.	22.5%	22.8%	22.4%	21.2%	22.5%	1.2	0.0
Operating profit	3.0%	1.6%	2.8%	0.4%	0.5%	0.2	(2.3)
Operating profit, adj.	4.0%	2.5%	4.1%	2.4%	1.4%	(1.0)	(2.7)
SBC	1.0%	0.9%	1.3%	2.1%	0.9%	(1.1)	(0.4)
Net profit	4.0%	2.6%	3.9%	1.3%	1.5%	0.2	(2.4)
Net profit, adj.	5.0%	3.5%	5.2%	3.4%	2.5%	(0.9)	(2.8)

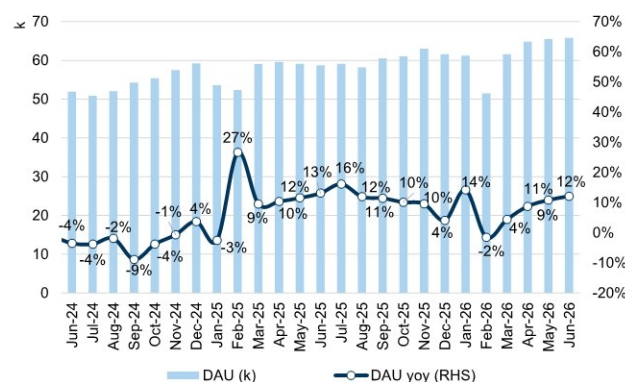
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: We expect the number of Tuhu workshops to grow +22% yoy to 9.8k in 2026E and exceed 10k+ by 2027E
Number of Tuhu workshops (year-end)



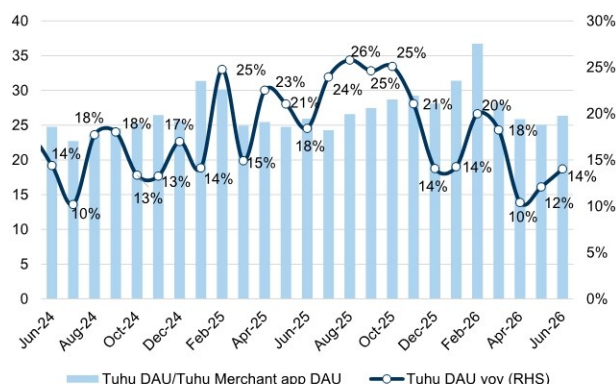
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Tuhu Merchant DAU increased +12% yoy to c.66k in Jun (vs. +11% yoy in May)



Source: Questmobile, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Tuhu DAU increased +14% yoy in Jun (vs. +12% yoy in May), while Tuhu DAU/Tuhu Merchant app DAU reached 26.4 in Jun (vs. 25.0 in May)



Source: Questmobile, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: We expect Tuhu's LTM transacting user to grow +18% yoy to c.31.3mn in 1H26E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Autohome (ATHM/2518.HK)

2518.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$37.5	Price: HK\$44.16	Downside: 15.1%
ATHM	12m Price Target: \$19	Price: \$22.74	Downside: 16.4%

Neutral	GS Forecast	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: \$2.7bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	6,452.0	4,789.2	4,953.2	5,021.5
Enterprise value: \$2.5bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	6,452.0	5,199.1	5,380.5	5,447.9
3m ADTV: \$14.4mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	1,137.3	459.8	753.7	816.4
China	EPS (Rmb) New	13.60	7.94	9.38	9.04
China Internet Verticals	EPS (Rmb) Old	13.60	8.72	10.42	10.01
M&A Rank: 2	P/E (X)	14.2	19.4	16.4	17.0
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	P/B (X)	0.9	0.7	0.8	0.8
	Dividend yield (%)	6.5	8.7	8.2	8.8
	CROCI (%)	5.1	0.9	2.7	3.7
	EPS (Rmb)	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		1.54	2.07	2.02	2.33

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 29 Jul 2026 close.

Exhibit 6: Autohome 2Q26E results preview

Rmb mn	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	New 2Q26E	QoQ (%)	YoY (%)
Media services	242	279	298	334	163	262	61%	-6%
Lead generation services	645	733	664	668	503	531	6%	-27%
Online marketplace & others	566	746	816	460	382	378	-1%	-49%
Total net revenues	1,454	1,758	1,778	1,462	1,048	1,171	12%	-33%
Cost of revenues	316	503	646	319	257	288	12%	-43%
Gross profit, GAAP	1,138	1,255	1,132	1,143	791	882	11%	-30%
Gross profit, non-GAAP	1,141	1,258	1,137	1,147	792	883	11%	-30%
Sales and marketing	544	630	620	739	506	513	1%	-18%
General and administrative	131	133	125	115	120	108	-10%	-18%
Product development	274	253	279	258	274	221	-19%	-13%
Total operating expenses, GAAP	949	1,016	1,024	1,112	900	843	-6%	-17%
Operating profit, GAAP	233	297	147	92	(34)	80	-332%	-73%
Operating profit, non-GAAP	279	349	222	139	2	116	7165%	-67%
Interest income	177	165	162	156	142	139	-2%	-16%
Gain/(Loss) from equity method invest	(12)	(0)	133	(18)	(56)	-	-100%	-100%
PBT, GAAP	399	461	442	230	52	219	319%	-53%
Income taxes	(56)	(61)	(18)	(6)	(25)	(35)	39%	-42%
Net income, GAAP	357	416	437	234	44	201	354%	-52%
Net income, non-GAAP	421	476	407	304	179	237	32%	-50%
ADS outstanding (mn), diluted	478	471	471	470	465	460	-1%	-2%
EPADS, GAAP (Rmb), diluted	2.85	3.38	3.56	1.93	0.38	1.75	359%	-48%
EPADS, non-GAAP (Rmb), diluted	3.52	4.04	3.45	2.59	1.54	2.07	34%	-49%

Margins (non-GAAP)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	New 2Q26E	QoQ (pp)	YoY (pp)
Gross margin	78.5%	71.6%	64.0%	78.4%	75.6%	75.5%	(0.1)	3.9
Operating margin	19.2%	19.9%	12.5%	9.5%	0.2%	9.9%	9.7	(10.0)
Net margin	28.9%	27.1%	22.9%	20.8%	17.1%	20.3%	3.2	(6.8)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis - Tuhu Car Inc.

Tuhu Car Inc. (9690.HK) is China's largest independent automotive aftermarket provider by revenue. Founded in 2011, Tuhu owns China's largest integrated online and offline auto service platform and enjoys high operational efficiency thanks to its digitalized solutions and standardized franchise model. We are constructive on the company's relatively resilient business nature, scalable business model driven by digitalized solutions and standardized franchisee expansion, as well as profitability expansion potential thanks to rising private-label sales and high operating leverage under a capital-light model. That said, we are Neutral rated as we see near-term visibility of margin expansion is limited, due to i) the company's more aggressive pricing strategy in exchange for market share gains, and ii) GPM pressure from raw material/merchandise cost increase as well as a potentially extended auto maintenance and part replacement cycle from rising oil prices.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Tuhu Car Inc.

We are Neutral rated on Tuhu Car Inc with a 12m target price of HK\$13 based on 15x 12m-fwd target P/E multiple. Key risks:(+) Accelerated market share expansion; (+) Private-label products growth and supply chain optimization; (+) Rapid scaling of high margin services; (-) Margin pressure from rising material costs; (-) Softer aftersales demand from changing consumer behavior; (-) Faster NEV penetration.

Investment Thesis - Autohome Inc.

Autohome Inc. (ATHM/2518.HK) is one of China's leading online automotive service platforms in terms of mobile active users. We are Neutral rated as we expect its media/leads revenue to stay under pressure as we are cautious on Autohome's wallet share in China's online auto ads and leads market. That said, we see new retail business as a new revenue growth driver as the company is transitioning from an auto information platform to a one-stop auto services platform. Also, the company provides an attractive shareholder return policy including no less than Rmb1.5bn in yearly dividends in 2026, announced a new share repurchase program in Jul 2026 with up to US\$400mn over the next 12 months post execution of US\$200mn buyback YTD, and in the longer term, plans to maintain a stable and proactive shareholder return framework consisting of dividend and repurchase.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Autohome Inc.

We are Neutral rated on ATHM/2518.HK with 12m target prices at US\$19/HK\$37.5, respectively with valuation methodology based on 1) an 85% weighting to fundamental value based on 13.5x target P/E applied to 2027E non-GAAP EPADS/EPS; and 2) a 15% weighting to a theoretical M&A value derived from 15x 12m-fwd target P/E multiple. Key risks: (-) bigger-than-expected decline in media/leads revenue; (-) below-expected execution on Autohome Space; (+/-) shareholder return policy revisions; (+/-) management turnover; (+) M&A events.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

I, Timothy Zhao, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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Quantum

Quantum is Goldman Sachs' proprietary database providing access to detailed financial statement histories, forecasts and ratios. It can be used for in-depth analysis of a single company, or to make comparisons between companies in different sectors and markets.

Disclosures

Rating and pricing information

Autohome Inc. (ADR) (Neutral, \$22.74), Autohome Inc. (H) (Neutral, HK\$44.16) and Tuhu Car Inc. (Neutral, HK\$11.68)

The rating(s) for Autohome Inc. (ADR), Autohome Inc. (H) and Tuhu Car Inc. is/are relative to the other companies in its/their coverage universe:

Autohome Inc. (ADR), Autohome Inc. (H), Beijing Sinnet Technology Co Ltd., East Buy, GDS Holdings (ADR), GDS Holdings (H), KE Holdings (ADR), KE Holdings (H), Kanzhun Ltd. (ADR), Kanzhun Ltd. (H), Kingsoft Cloud, Ming Yuan Cloud, New Oriental Education & Technology (ADR), New Oriental Education & Technology (H), Offcn Education Technology, Range Intelligent, SUNeVision Holdings, Shanghai Athub, TAL Education Group, Tuhu Car Inc., Tuya, VNET Group, Weibo Corp. (ADR), Weibo Corp. (H), Weimob, Xiaomi Corp.

Company-specific regulatory disclosures

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Goldman Sachs beneficially owned 1% or more of common equity (excluding positions managed by affiliates and business units not required to be aggregated under US securities law) as of the month end preceding this report: Autohome Inc. (ADR) (\$22.74) and Autohome Inc. (H) (HK\$44.16)

Goldman Sachs has received compensation for investment banking services in the past 12 months: Autohome Inc. (ADR) (\$22.74), Autohome Inc. (H) (HK\$44.16) and Tuhu Car Inc. (HK\$11.68)

Goldman Sachs expects to receive or intends to seek compensation for investment banking services in the next 3 months: Autohome Inc. (ADR) (\$22.74), Autohome Inc. (H) (HK\$44.16) and Tuhu Car Inc. (HK\$11.68)

Goldman Sachs has received compensation for non-investment banking services during the past 12 months: Autohome Inc. (ADR) (\$22.74) and Autohome Inc. (H) (HK\$44.16)

Goldman Sachs had an investment banking services client relationship during the past 12 months with: Autohome Inc. (ADR) (\$22.74), Autohome Inc. (H) (HK\$44.16) and Tuhu Car Inc. (HK\$11.68)

Goldman Sachs had a non-investment banking securities-related services client relationship during the past 12 months with: Autohome Inc. (ADR) (\$22.74), Autohome Inc. (H) (HK\$44.16) and Tuhu Car Inc. (HK\$11.68)

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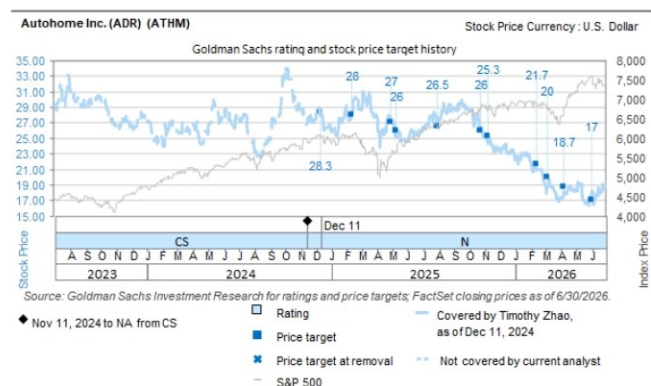
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

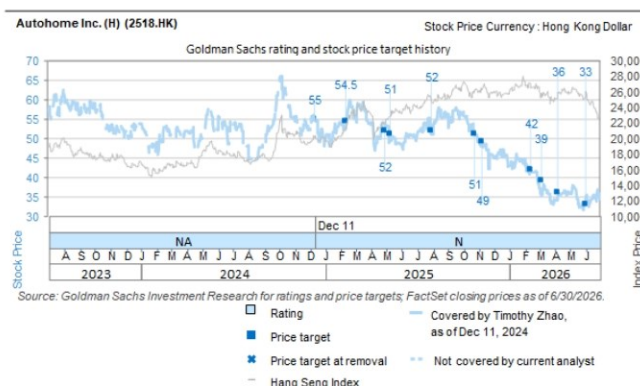
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

As of July 1, 2026, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research had investment ratings on 3,104 equity securities. Goldman Sachs assigns stocks as Buys and Sells on various regional Investment Lists; stocks not so assigned are deemed Neutral. Such assignments equate to Buy, Hold and Sell for the purposes of the above disclosure required by the FINRA Rules. See 'Ratings, Coverage universe and related definitions' below. The Investment Banking Relationships chart reflects the percentage of subject companies within each rating category for whom Goldman Sachs has provided investment banking services within the previous twelve months.

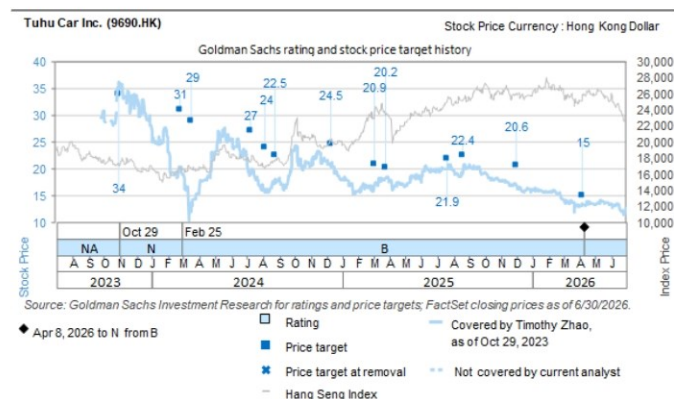
Price target and rating history chart(s)



The price targets shown should be considered in the context of all prior published Goldman Sachs research, which may or may not have included price targets, as well as developments relating to the company, its industry and financial markets.



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Target price history table(s)

Autohome Inc. (ADR) (ATHM)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
01-Jun-26	17.00	17.91
08-Apr-26	18.70	18.12
05-Mar-26	20.00	18.83
12-Feb-26	21.70	21.03
09-Nov-25	25.30	24.34
24-Oct-25	26.00	25.99
31-Jul-25	26.50	27.09
09-May-25	26.00	25.16
28-Apr-25	27.00	27.94
10-Feb-25	28.00	28.00
11-Dec-24	28.30	27.88

Tuohu Car Inc. (9690.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
08-Apr-26	15.00	13.52
02-Dec-25	20.60	16.96
21-Aug-25	22.40	19.06
22-Jul-25	21.90	20.05
25-Mar-25	20.20	18.32
06-Mar-25	20.90	17.50
11-Dec-24	24.50	20.45
25-Aug-24	22.50	17.36
07-Aug-24	24.00	16.20
09-Jul-24	27.00	19.30
18-Mar-24	29.00	13.70

Autohome Inc. (ADR) (ATHM)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
25-Feb-24	31.00	20.40
29-Oct-23	34.00	35.20

Tuhu Car Inc. (9690.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
25-Feb-24	31.00	20.40
29-Oct-23	34.00	35.20

Autohome Inc. (H) (2518.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
01-Jun-26	33.00	33.96
08-Apr-26	36.00	35.08
05-Mar-26	39.00	35.28
12-Feb-26	42.00	41.22
09-Nov-25	49.00	49.16
24-Oct-25	51.00	51.15
31-Jul-25	52.00	51.05
09-May-25	51.00	49.90
28-Apr-25	52.00	53.95
10-Feb-25	54.50	52.50
11-Dec-24	55.00	54.75

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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